The Son of Peace Embodies China Mission 2030



by Luis Bush

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Son of peace embodied the vision of an historic event in which more than one thousand servants of God from twenty seven of the thirty-two provinces of China eagerly participated. “Many of those present commented that never in house church history had they seen so many people from so diversified backgrounds gathered together. Its impact on the unity of Chinese churches and cross-cultural missions is likely to be quite profound.” Email from Franklin Wang” (Email October 25, 2016).

This was one more sign of a new chapter in global missions representing a China Mission wave that is spreading across the nations as the Man of Peace. Peace/Shalom is the way the Chinese Christian church approaches people from all nations, including and especially reaching out to the people of Islam as well the people of Israel. A global perspective on the Mission China Movement recognizes and affirms this New Power of Peace.

The uniqueness about the China Mission is a call for Back to Jerusalem with all nations with the new power of peace and to all nations offering the peace that surpasses all understanding. It is all about the Gospel as the good news of peace.

The Chinese Church's global mission--Back to Jerusalem Movement comes on the heels of Israel's journey back to Jerusalem. It comes after Jesus' journey back to Jerusalem. And it follows Paul the Apostle's Back to Jerusalem mission.

The biblical foundation for the Mission China Movement New Power of Peace comes from the Old Testament book of Isaiah the prophet. In the book of Isaiah, the concept of peace comes from God's power over His created order. According to Isaiah the prophet, peace results from a person subjecting himself or herself appropriately to God in relationship.

The Word of God makes it clear that God desires for all people to gladly recognize and experience His peace in all its fullness. The term peace appears as the Hebrew Word shalom which has the meaning of favorable friendly terms such as ease, soundness, welfare, peace, prosperity! It refers to wholeness or well-being in general as well as to political and interpersonal peace in community. Shalom is the state of being whole. Consider the term Shalom in the biblical foundation of Back to Jerusalem with all nations and Mission China Movement with roots of biblical understanding in the book of Isaiah the prophet.

Our hope in the pursuit of peace is in the Prince of Peace as spoken of by Isaiah in 9:6 "His name will be called Wonderful Counselor, Mighty God, Eternal Father, Prince of Peace." "For," Isaiah explains: "to us a child is born, to us a son is given, and the government will be on his shoulders. Of the increase of his government and peace (Shalom) there will be no end. He will reign on David's throne and over his kingdom, establishing and upholding it with justice and righteousness from that time on and forever (Is. 9:7). We see Jesus reigning over His Kingdom… a kingdom that will never end!"

The Hebrew word for "peace," shalom, is used about tranquility of individuals and good relations among and between groups and nations. Creating peace on their lips. "The words point primarily to the praise and thanksgiving of the pardoned sinner." The Lord will cause the word "peace" to spring forth spontaneously, from those who experience His lovingkindness. Peace, peace, to the far and to the near," says the LORD, "and I will heal him," Is 57:19.

Why the Chinese Mission power of peace? The answer . . . for three reasons: 1. The power of the pursuit of peace 2. The promise of the pursuit of peace and 3. The product of the pursuit of peace. The power of the pursuit of peace with all peoples is described for us in Isaiah 14:7 "All the lands are at rest and at peace; they break out into

singing." Now all the world is at peace; its people are celebrating with joyful songs. The promise of the pursuit of peace, of Shalom, comes in Isaiah 26:3 "You will keep in perfect peace those whose minds remain focused on you, because he remains in you." The Lord gives perfect peace to those whose faith is firm. The product of the pursuit of peace can be found in 26:12. "LORD, you establish peace for us; all that we have accomplished you have done for us." You will give us peace, Lord, because everything we have done was by your power. We become the Lord's people and so Isaiah writes in 32:18 "My people will live in peaceful dwelling places, in secure homes, in undisturbed places of rest."

For you who go forth as missionaries and sending churches this word from Isaiah 52:7 is especially for you: "How beautiful on the mountains are the feet of those who bring good news, who proclaim peace, who bring good tidings, who proclaim salvation, who say to Zion, "Your God reigns!"

The cost was so great. It cost Jesus his life; Jesus who is both the definition of shalom and the incarnation of God's shalom. As Isaiah 53:5 "But he was pierced for our transgressions, he was crushed for our iniquities; the punishment that brought us peace (Shalom) was upon him, and by his wounds we are healed." Jesus paid it all and He has the last word in Isaiah 66:12 "For this is what the Lord says: 'I will extend peace to her like a river, and the wealth of nations like a flooding stream.'"

A new chapter in global missions has begun with Mission China 2030--the New Power of Peace/Shalom to all nations. Now begins a movement of missions moving westward from Beijing to Jerusalem completing circle in the power of God with the peace of God. Is 26:12 You will give us peace, Lord, because everything we have done was by your power.

As God said in Isaiah 49:6 to his servant Israel in times gone by so He says to you who have ventured out on a Chinese Mission to the world: "It's too small a thing for you to be my servant to restore Israel I will also make you a light for the nations so that my salvation may reach to the ends of the earth."

The Power of Peace Blessing – a dedication to China Mission 2030. God desires all people gladly recognize and experience His peace in all its fullness. The Word of God reiterates the vision, mission, and anticipation when the whole world is filled with the knowledge of the glory of God as the waters cover the sea.

In the glory of God, we discover the power of God. In the glory of God, we encounter the presence of God. In the glory of God, we experience the peace of the Lord. Now may the God of peace (Rom. 15:33) grant you who are engaged in China Mission 2030 the peace that surpasses all understanding to guard your hearts and your minds in Christ Jesus, such that you experience the power of the peace *of God* (Phil 4:7) the power of peace *with God* (Rom 5:1) as you go forth on his mission.

May you experience the power of peace which is, as Paul said in 2 Thess. 3:16 "Now the Lord of peace Himself give you peace always by all means, including the peace of a quiet conscience (Rom. 8:33-35), the peace of a restful mind (Phil. 4:7) and the peace of a surrendered will so that you may become the channel of Peace.

To all our Chinese friends in China Mission 2030 we say: "May the peace—the shalom of our LORD be with you in all circumstances for, as Jesus said, as recorded in Luke 10:6, When those who are there are peaceful, the blessing will stand.